

Got it  — here's a **minimal valid** `package_index.json` **example** that passes the schema I gave you and works with Arduino CLI / IDE Boards Manager.

This example defines a fictional vendor "myvendor" with one platform and one tool.

Minimal `package_index.json`

```
{
  "packages": [
    {
      "name": "myvendor",
      "maintainer": "My Vendor Inc.",
      "websiteURL": "https://example.com",
      "email": "support@example.com",
      "help": {
        "online": "https://example.com/help"
      },
      "platforms": [
        {
          "name": "MyVendor AVR Boards",
          "architecture": "avr",
          "version": "1.0.0",
          "category": "Contributed",
          "url": "https://example.com/downloads/myvendor-avr-1.0.0.tar.bz2",
          "archiveFileName": "myvendor-avr-1.0.0.tar.bz2",
          "checksum": "SHA-
256:0123456789abcdef0123456789abcdef0123456789abcdef0123456789abcdef",
          "size": 123456,
          "boards": [
            { "name": "MyVendor Uno" }
          ],
          "toolsDependencies": [
            {
              "packager": "myvendor",
              "name": "mytool",
              "version": "1.0.0"
            }
          ]
        }
      ]
    }
  ]
}
```

```

    ]
  }
],
"tools": [
  {
    "name": "mytool",
    "versions": [
      {
        "version": "1.0.0",
        "systems": [
          {
            "host": "i686-mingw32",
            "url": "https://example.com/downloads/mytool-1.0.0-
windows.zip",
            "archiveFileName": "mytool-1.0.0-windows.zip",
            "checksum": "SHA-
256:abcdefabcdefabcdefabcdefabcdefabcdefabcdefabcdef",
            "size": 654321
          }
        ]
      }
    ]
  }
]
}
]
}

```

How to Test with Arduino CLI

1. Save the file as `package_index.json` and host it on a web server (or local file path).
2. Add it to Arduino CLI:

```

arduino-cli config init
arduino-cli config add board_manager.additional_urls

```

```
https://example.com/package_index.json
```

3. Update index:

```
arduino-cli core update-index
```

4. Install the platform:

```
arduino-cli core install myvendor:avr
```

If you want, I can also give you a **stripped-down “single-board, no-tools” version** of this JSON that’s even smaller for quick testing.

Do you want me to prepare that ultra-minimal version?